

Epson Stylus CX 5100

A premium multi-functional device

Multi-functional devices seems to be the *mantra* of recent times—the Epson Stylus CX 5100 can scan, print and copy documents in colour and monochrome. It is targeted at the SoHo (Small Office Home Office) segment, and is not meant for heavy-duty print or copy jobs.

The CX 5100 sports elegant looks and a fairly small footprint. There is a small LCD display for selecting paper, print



quality, number of copies and so on, using a neat and easy to use set of buttons on the front face.

The CX 5100 has individually changeable ink cartridges. It supports a maximum printing resolution of 5760 dpi (interpolated) and claims a maximum printing speed of 22 ppm in economy mode. The paper capacity is 150 sheets and it is top-loading.

The flat-bed scanner has an optical resolution of 1200 x 2400 at a colour depth of 48 bits. It comes with a transport lock that prevents the scanner lamp from moving while transportation. Setting up the device was an easy job as it comes with a USB interface. Windows XP detected the printer instantly, and installed the drivers without

any trouble.

The device took around 17 seconds and 27 seconds respectively to print a full sized monochrome text document in normal mode and best quality mode, which is quite impressive. But we were disappointed by the print quality—there was some smudging which continued even after a number of prints. In the photo printing capability test, the colour reproduction was not accurate and the overall contrast was poor, even on photo paper. It simply failed to impress.

But to our surprise, the scanner made for lost ground by producing some stunning scans that were brilliant in every aspect. The only negative thing we noted was a little drop in the brightness level. Its document scanning was also satisfactory, and it passed the OCR test with reasonable accuracy. Document copying is very simple: place the document to be copied on the scanner bed, and select Colour or B&W using a button on the top. The copies were of acceptable quality; the settings, however, were non-changeable.

At Rs 22,500, the CX 5100 a premium product as far as pricing is concerned. And overall, the CX 5100 has excellent scanning capabilities and below average print quality.

SPECIFICATIONS

Maximum resolution: 5760 x 1440 dpi, A4 flat bed scanner, maximum optical resolution: 1200 x 2400 dpi, 150 Paper capacity and USB interface

Epson Stylus CX 5100

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Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 22,500
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Asus V9180/TD

GeForce4 for the masses

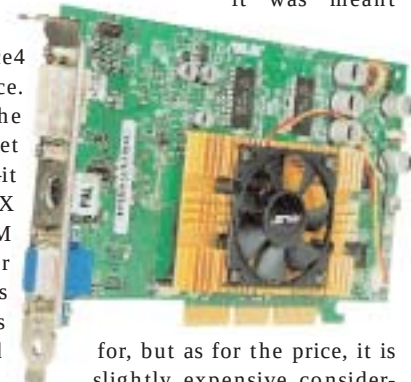
Asus has a reputation for building some of the most feature-packed and robust nVidia chipset cards. Enter the V9180/TD. The chip is meant for those who want the GeForce4 tag at an affordable price. This card is based on the GeForce4 MX440 chipset with one addition—it features the new AGP 8X standard. The Video RAM is 128 MB—enough for you to play your games without framing. As usual, the extras provided by Asus include a pack of games.

Instead of running at 270 MHz (GPU) and 400 MHz DDR like its predecessor, these cards are set to 275 and MHz. This gets that extra oomph into your gaming.

The card does not feature either a pixel or a vertex shader, so you won't be able to play upcoming games with the eye-candy enabled. But

The frame rates in *Quake III* were good; so was the Direct3D performance.

This card does well what it was meant



for, but as for the price, it is slightly expensive considering the specifications; newer cards based on the FX5200 chipset retail for nearly the same price.

SPECIFICATIONS

256-bit architecture, 275 MHz clock, 0.15 micron fabrication, AGP 8x, 128-bit 500 MHz DDR 128 MB video RAM, 400 MHz RAMDAC, max resolution of 2048 X 1536 @ 85 Hz.

Asus V9180/TD

B

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 7,200

Contact: Asus India

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Logitech Momo Force Feedback Wheel

Must-have accessory for the hardcore gamer

The 'Momo' on the Logitech Force Feedback Wheel comes from the fact that it is designed by professionals from Momo, who specialise in building gear knobs, steering wheels and such, for F1 racing cars.

The rubber-clad wheel offers excellent grip and smooth, jerk free movement. It sports a maximum rotation angle of 240 degrees. The centre of

the wheel has six programmable buttons. It also has two paddle shifters behind it, and the gear knob is at a fairly reachable position. Both the paddles and

